

Drainage Board Meeting August 13th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=P1KvNMNkwyM
Publication Date	2025-08-14T02:07:37Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Drainage Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: August 13, 2025

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Drainage Board was called to order on August 13, 2025. Presiding officer noted that Mr. Whitehead was absent, and another board member ran the meeting.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Hamilton, Mr. Rian (also referred to in roll as Mr. Mand/G.), Mr. Christie, Mr. Buffalo (Ball), Mr. Wright, Mr. Ber.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Whitehead.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Unidentified acting chair (filling in for Mr. Whitehead).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance, followed by a formal roll call.
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- **July 9, 2025 Minutes:** Tabled because they were not sent out for review prior to the meeting.
- **Disposition:** Tabled by a formal roll call vote (Yes: Hamilton, Mand/G., Christie, Ball).
Note: A correction regarding a dollar amount (\$600,000 vs. \$60,000) for 6701 East Hickory Lane was noted for inclusion when the minutes are brought back.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

No formal ordinances, resolutions, or contracts were voted on as substantive agenda items, aside from administrative claim approvals and procedural tabling actions covered under other sections.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:01:06 Cody Light (9800 North County Road, 525 West Gaston):**
 - *Topic:* Addressed ongoing drainage issues and tile blowouts involving the Rector drain running through his property. Stated that 4 acres of his ground flood out during heavy rains, preventing agricultural use. Complained about poor communication from the surveyor's office and suggested adding a digital submission form on the county website for log jams and tile blowouts.
 - *Surveyor/Board Response:* Surveyor Tom noted he recently visited the site after wheat harvest, saw flags/indentions, and confirmed a contractor is scheduled to scope/re-shoot and repair the tile line. The board/surveyor also agreed to coordinate with GIS (Kyle) regarding the digital website form.
- **00:01:51 Don Chambers (215 East Bosman Street, Eaton):**
 - *Topic:* Raised an issue regarding a neighbor on Romy Street in Straw Town who brought in truckloads of dirt, backing up a natural waterway into neighboring woods and property, killing trees and causing flooding. Offered photos to the board.
 - *Surveyor/Board Response:* The surveyor stated this was the first he had heard of it and invited Chambers to bring his address and photos down to the office to file a formal complaint.
- **[00:01:40 / 00:19:40] Shane Henry (County Commissioner):**
 - *Topic:* Brought forward a complaint on behalf of Dale Buffin (1101 / 1351 South County Road 625 East) regarding the Leaper ditch flooding, property damage to a back garage, and a newly built house upstream where trees were cleared and mud/fill may have disrupted the tile/ditch line.
 - *Surveyor/Board Response:* Surveyor Tom noted the contractor was already out probing and flagging that tile line earlier in the week and is awaiting utility locates to begin digging and resolving the issue.
- **00:23:02 Steven Brandell (County Commissioner):**

- *Topic:* Provided an update regarding the Stockport Drive structure over a county ditch. Stated that affected residents refused to sign the county's agreement to take over future maintenance, so the commissioners are sending a registered letter stating the county will perform the work for public safety reasons while maintaining that residents remain responsible moving forward.
 - *Board Response:* Discussed coordination with highway department mowing and weed-eating schedules.
 - **00:28:05 Dennis Rogers (Dunkerk area):**
 - *Topic:* Inquired about the status of the Racer Ditch de-brushing/clearing project west of Dunkerk. Expressed concern that the current contractor is inexperienced, underequipped, and failed to complete the work within the 90-day window and 30-day extension.
 - *Surveyor/Board Response:* The surveyor confirmed the work is incomplete, debris has not been removed or burned, and right-of-way clearing standards were not met. The board discussed rebidding the project.
 - **00:33:56 Tim Hollingsworth (10,600 North Gaston):**
 - *Topic:* Noted his farm drains into the Rector drain (passing through Cody Light's field) and highlighted depressions over old clay tile north of McCollum Road where a homeowner repeatedly fills sinkholes with dirt, treating the tile like an open creek. Also asked about status of three other reported broken county tiles in Harrison and Washington townships.
 - *Surveyor/Board Response:* Surveyor Tom agreed to look into the three reported township locations and follow up.
 - **00:38:56 Wayne Johns & Brandy Hoff (8309 / 8209 East County Road 350 North, Albany):**
 - *Topic:* Petitioned for the removal of an obstruction specifically a 0-to-4-foot earthen embankment/mound of excess clay soil created from a neighbor's newly constructed pond that completely blocks natural surface water runoff and causes standing water on their property.
 - *Neighbor (Brandy Hoff) Testimony:* Defended the pond construction, stating it followed DNR guidelines, sits more than 75 feet from a regulated drain, and asserted rights under the common enemy doctrine regarding surface water.
 - *Legal & Board Deliberation:* Board attorney advised that while the board has the discretion to handle obstruction requests under Indiana code, it is not legally obligated to do so, and the dispute leans heavily toward a civil matter requiring private counsel.
 - *Action:* **00:52:12** A motion was made and seconded to **table the issue** for further investigation.
 - *Vote:* Passed Unanimously by roll call vote (Yes: Hamilton, G., Christie, Bo).
-

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Old Business & Racer Ditch Contract:**
 - The board addressed the failed de-brushing contract with Mr. Arnold for the Racer Ditch (where the 30-day extension expired on meeting day).
 - *Action:* The board instructed the surveyor to notify the contractor to stop working, prepare updated specifications, and rebid the project exceeding the \$10,000 threshold to experienced contractors for completion by fall.
- **Approval of Maintenance Claims:**
 - Reviewed maintenance claims, including de-brushing/spraying claims and a minor fund-coding correction noted by Mr. Hamilton regarding a JJC excavating purchase order.
 - *Disposition:* Approved by roll call vote (Yes: Hamilton, G., Christie, Bo).
- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The surveyor noted he met with Culie to televise drainage issues near Woodlawn Park and will coordinate solutions with county highway/commissioners (noted as a neighborhood issue rather than a regulated drain).
- **Adjournment:** Official motion and second to adjourn carried by roll call vote.

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-27 02:01:56 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.